



School Life in China

Campus life, K-12 education, and student experiences

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Article 1

Campus Life in China: What to Expect as an International Student

Starting university in China is a unique experience. Here's what daily campus life looks like for international students.

Orientation Week

Most universities hold a dedicated orientation for international students, typically 1-2 weeks before classes begin. You'll receive your student ID, campus tour, library card, and bank account setup assistance. Many universities assign a Chinese "buddy" student to help you settle in.

Daily Schedule

Classes typically run from 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM, with a 2-hour lunch break. Morning classes start at 8:00 AM (早八) -- this is earlier than most Western universities! Most students eat breakfast at the campus canteen around 7:00-7:30 AM.

Campus Canteens (食堂)

The heart of campus life. Meals cost ¥8-20 per dish. Most canteens have multiple floors with different cuisine options. Payment via WeChat/Alipay or campus card. International student dining halls in major cities offer more diverse food options.

Dormitory Life

On-campus dorms cost ¥800-2,500/year. Most rooms are shared (2-4 students). Facilities typically include: shared bathrooms, laundry room, common study area, hot water (often limited hours), and internet access. Some universities offer single rooms for international students at higher rates.

Student Organizations

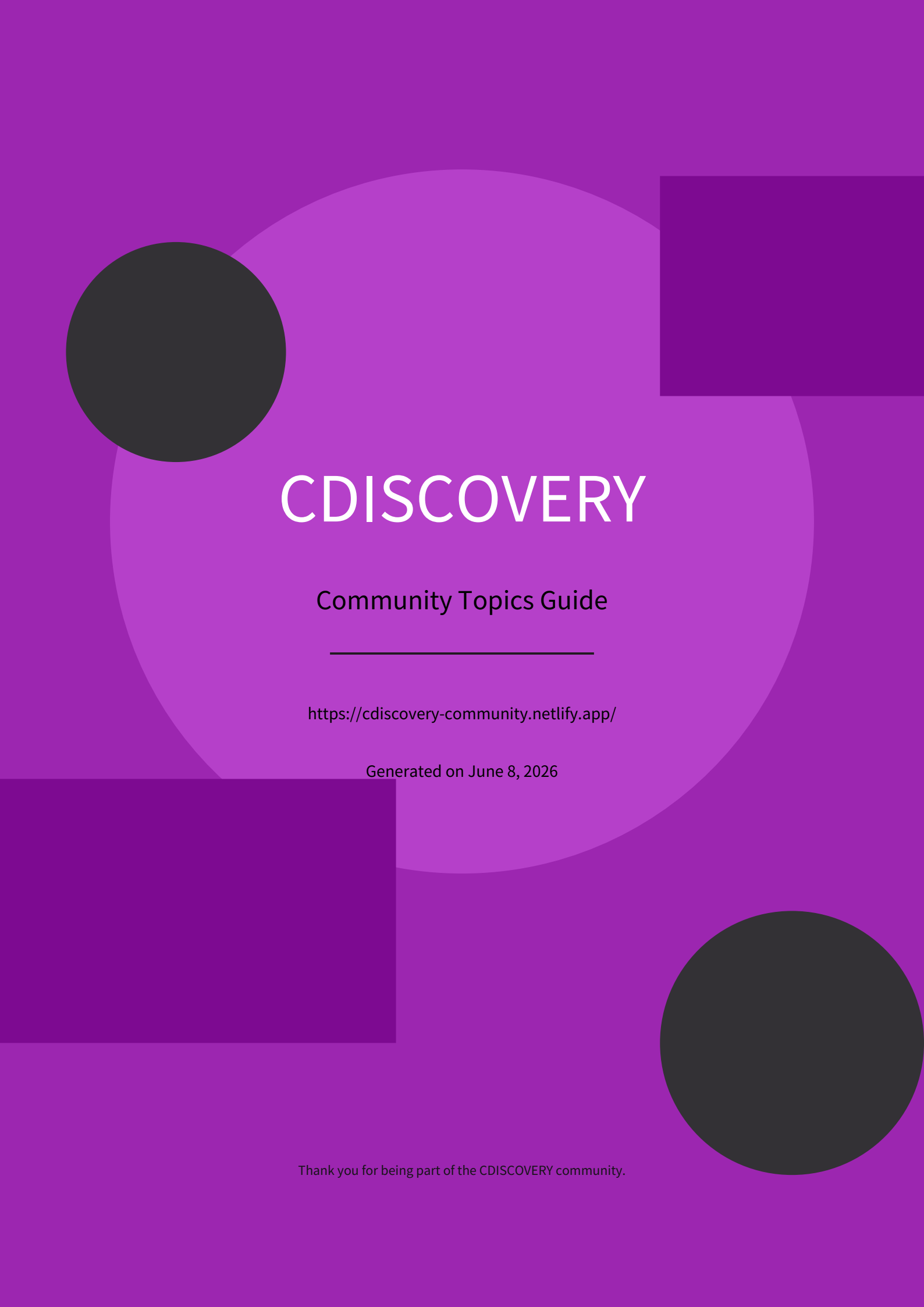
Over 100 student clubs at most universities, covering: sports (basketball, football, badminton), arts (calligraphy, traditional music, dance), technology (robotics, AI, coding), language exchange, and cultural activities. Joining clubs is the best way to make Chinese friends.

Useful Campus Resources:

- * International Student Office -- visa issues, academic advising, cultural activities
- * Library -- extensive digital resources, study rooms, free printing (limited)
- * Career Center -- resume workshops, job fairs, internship connections
- * Health Center -- basic medical care, ¥5-15 consultation fee
- * Sports facilities -- gym, pool, tennis courts (often free or ¥5-20/session)

Sources: Sources: <http://www.moe.gov.cn> Ministry of Education • <http://www.ecnu.edu.cn>

<http://www.ecnu.edu.cn> East China Normal University

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